

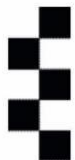


Assignment Grading Criteria

The University of Essex Online – Undergraduate Grading Criteria NQF Level 5.

(Each assessment specific marking criteria will be developed using the standard criteria below. The weighting for each element within the table may vary between assessments).

Criteria	80-100% (Exceptional - 1st)	70-79% (1 st)	60-69% (2:1)	50-59% (2:2)	40-49% (3rd)	30-39% (Marginal Fail)	20-30% (Fail)	20%> (Fail)
Knowledge and understanding of the subject area / conceptual issues under consideration Demonstrable understanding of course materials and their relevance to the assessment. Weighting: 25%	High quality work showing detailed faultless knowledge and understanding of the established concepts, principles and theories. Demonstrates a sound awareness of the strengths and weaknesses of the knowledge base.	High quality work showing detailed knowledge and understanding of the established concepts, principles and theories. Demonstrates some early awareness of the strengths and weaknesses of the knowledge base.	Work of solid quality showing competent and consistent understanding of the established concepts and principles of the subject(s).	Adequate work showing understanding of the established concepts and principles of the subject(s) but lacking depth and breadth.	Simple factual approach showing limited understanding of the established concepts and principles of the subject(s). Narrow or misguided selection of course material, with elements missing or inaccurate.	Weak work showing limited but fragmentary understanding of the established concepts and principles of the subject(s), for example through inaccuracies, inclusion of irrelevant course material and/or absence of appropriate information.	Unsatisfactory work showing weak and flawed understanding of the established concepts and principles of the subject(s), for example through serious inaccuracies, inclusion of a significant amount of irrelevant course material and/or absence of appropriate information.	Highly unsatisfactory work showing major gaps in understanding of the established concepts and principles of the subject(s). Inclusion of largely irrelevant course material, absence of appropriate information and significant inaccuracies.
Application of theory to practice and or real-world example	Excellent application of theory to practice, the student makes highly appropriate, developed and articulated links	Highly competent application of theory to practice, the student makes highly appropriate, developed and	Sound application of theory to practice, with the student making appropriate, well developed and	Consistent and accurate application of theory to practice, with the student making	Relevant theoretical knowledge and understanding applied in practice, but with students	Limited understanding of the application of theory to practice, with the student often not making	Weak understanding of the application of theory to practice, with only occasional	Very weak theoretical knowledge and understanding, with no evidence of appropriate



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Where applicable the student should demonstrate reflection and an application of theory to their work practice. Weighting: 25%	between the two and may begin to demonstrate early suggestions of theory development.	articulated links between the two.	articulated links between the two.	appropriate links between the two.	not always making logical links between the two.	appropriate links between the two.	evidence of the student making appropriate links between the two.	application in practice.
Critical Analysis and Evaluation Students should demonstrate their intellectual skills at the appropriate level of their study. Demonstrable emergence of critical analysis developing for higher grade bands. Weighting: 25%	Use of excellent critical, analytical and evaluative skills in order to develop highly logical and coherent judgements / arguments, supported by a range of relevant evidence. Strong evidence of independent thinking and creativity. Explicit discussion of a range of viewpoints with strong awareness of the limits of their knowledge.	Use of excellent critical, analytical and evaluative skills in order to develop highly logical and coherent judgements / arguments, supported by a range of relevant evidence. Some, perhaps limited, evidence of independent thinking and creativity. Some discussion of other viewpoints and an awareness of the limits of their knowledge.	Use of sound critical, analytical and evaluative skills in order to develop logical and coherent judgements / arguments, supported by relevant evidence. Some evidence of originality. Demonstrates a sound awareness of other viewpoints and a good awareness of the limits of their knowledge.	Evidence of use of evaluation and critical analysis to support the development of logical and coherent judgements / arguments, supported by relevant evidence. An awareness of other viewpoints and of the limits of their knowledge.	Limited and inconsistent use of evaluation and critical analysis to support emerging judgements or arguments, although not always logical or coherent and with inaccuracies. Limited awareness of other viewpoints and the limits of their knowledge.	Largely descriptive work, with very little effort made to use evaluation and critical analysis to develop judgements or arguments. Information accepted uncritically, with unsubstantiated opinions evident.	Descriptive work with no effort made to use evaluation or critical analysis to develop judgements or arguments. Views expressed are often illogical, invalid or irrelevant. Minimal or no use of evidence to support views.	Work is largely irrelevant or inaccurate, characterised by descriptive text and unsubstantiated generalisations. Minimal or no use of evidence to support views.



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Reading and Referencing The most up to date APA Style of Referencing should be followed. Marks will not be deducted for using older versions, but feedback/directions to newest version given. The majority of the reading will be from journal articles and course textbooks, with evidence of some wider reading beyond materials recommended on the platform. Weighting: 15%	Critical engagement with a wide range of relevant reading / source material, including research-informed literature where relevant. Begins to demonstrate foundations of original thought Consistently accurate application of referencing with no errors.	Critical engagement with a wide range of relevant reading, including research-informed literature where relevant. Consistently accurate application of referencing.	Engagement with a wide range of relevant reading / source material. Sound application of referencing, with no inaccuracies or inconsistencies.	Engagement with an appropriate range of reading / source materials beyond essential texts. Referencing may show minor inaccuracies or inconsistencies.	Evidence of reading, largely limited to essential texts, but mainly reliant on taught elements of the module. Referencing may show inaccuracies and/or inconsistencies.	Poor engagement with essential texts and no evidence of wider reading. Heavily reliant on taught elements of the module. Inconsistent and weak use of referencing.	Limited evidence of reading and/or reliance on inappropriate sources. Limited engagement with taught elements of the module. Very poor use of referencing.	No evidence of reading or engagement with taught elements of the module. Non-existent or incoherent referencing.
Presentation Style and Structure Weighting: 10%	Compelling presentation of work that is appropriately and coherently structured and clearly articulated throughout. Accurate use of an Academic Writing style. No errors in grammar,	Compelling Presentation of work that is appropriately and coherently structured and clearly articulated throughout. Accurate use of an Academic Writing	Competent presentation of work in terms of structure and articulation of ideas. Appropriate academic writing style adopted. Grammar, punctuation and	Work is structured in a coherent manner and is mostly clearly articulated. Some attempt to adopt an academic writing style. Grammar, punctuation, and	Acceptable presentation in which relevant ideas / concepts are reasonably articulated. Academic writing style may be weak in some areas, Grammar,	Work is loosely, and at times incoherently, structured, with information and ideas mostly poorly articulated. Academic writing style poor. Grammar, spelling	Work is poorly presented in a disjointed and incoherent manner. Concepts, theories and ideas are very poorly articulated, weak English and/or inappropriate	Work is extremely disorganised, with much of the content is articulated in a confusing way. Very poor English and/or very inappropriate style of writing. Multiple

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	punctuation, or spelling.	style. Accurate grammar, punctuation, or spelling. There may be minor errors in one of: presentation, spelling / grammar / punctuation or writing style.	spelling are mainly correct.	spelling may contain some errors.	punctuation, and spelling may contain some errors.	and punctuation may have multiple errors.	writing style, multiple errors. Grammar, spelling and punctuation errors.	errors throughout the piece of work.
Criteria	80-100% (Exceptional - 1st)	70-79% (1 st)	60-69% (2:1)	50-59% (2:2)	40-49% (3rd)	30-39% (Marginal Fail)	20-30% (Fail)	20%> (Fail)